



Deutsche Bank
Research

Q3 2026 Global Markets Survey

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With special thanks to Anthony Chaimowitz from dbDataInsights team

Deutsche Bank Research Institute

IMPORTANT RESEARCH DISCLOSURES LOCATED IN APPENDIX 1.

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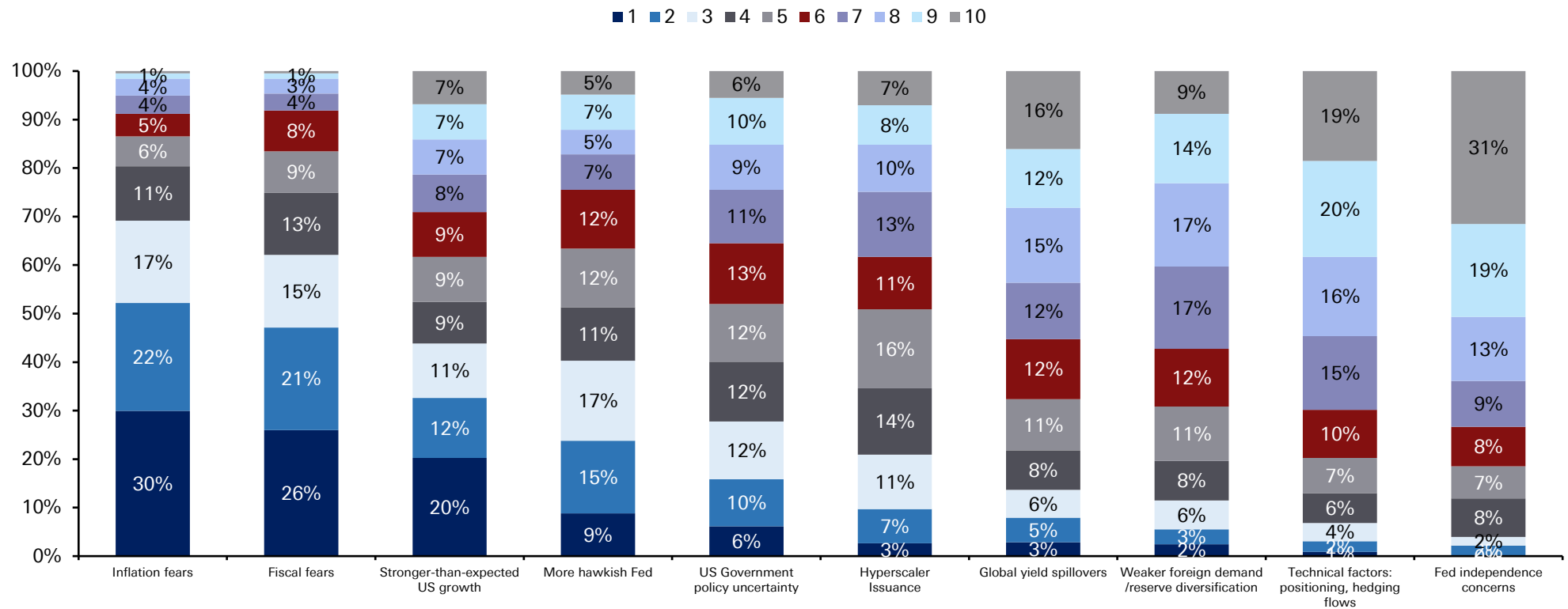


Our Q3 2026 global financial markets survey had 460 responses from around the world, conducted between September 28th and October 1st.

With the ongoing major bond selloff, we asked respondents to rank what they thought were the most important drivers. Inflation, fiscal fears, and stronger-than-expected US growth were picked as the most important drivers. 30% picked inflation as the most important driver even though 10yr US Breakevens have hardly moved in the selloff.



Thinking about the recent rise in US Treasury yields, please rank the following factors in order of importance, from the most important driver to the least important. Please drag and drop the factors into the order that best represents your view of their importance.

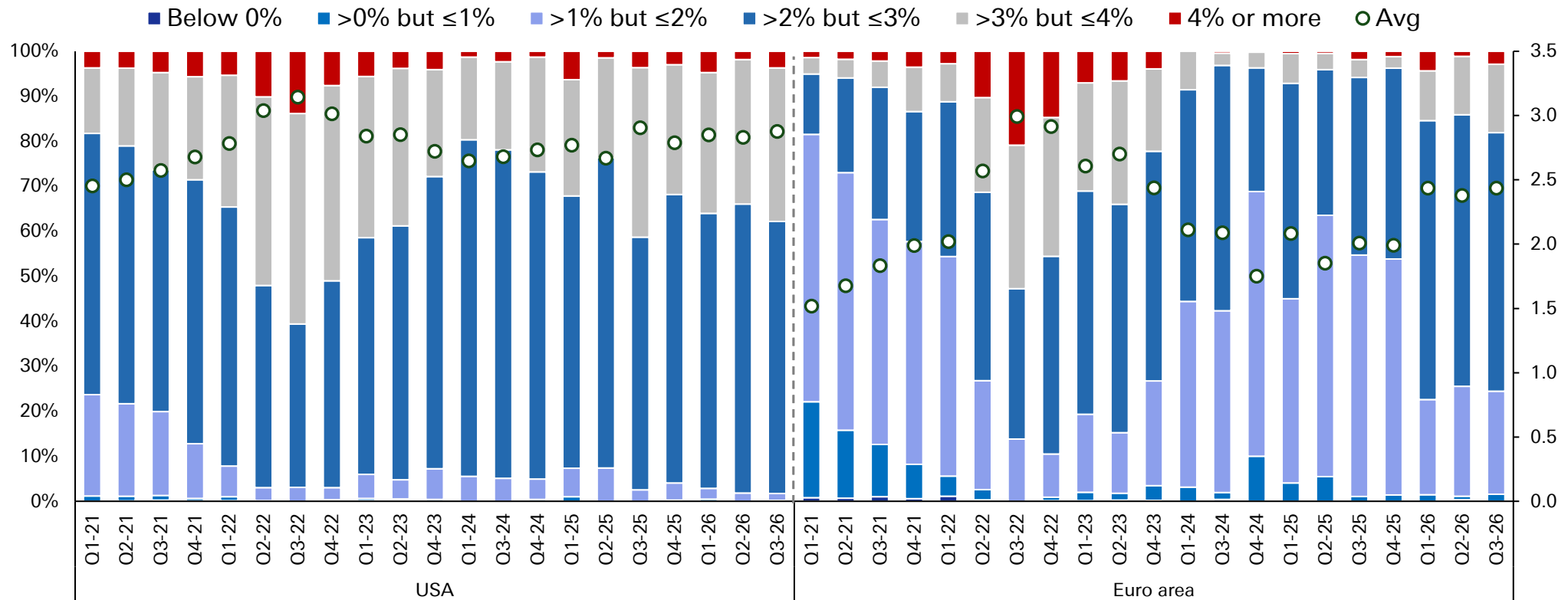


Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research



To highlight the inconsistency, US inflation expectations over the next 5 years have risen only marginally since we last asked in June, back up to 2.9% from 2.8%. 5yr European inflation expectations are unchanged at 2.4%. So while there is a strong narrative that inflation is causing the bond selloff, it doesn't stack up with long-term inflation expectations.

Looking at the below, what do you think inflation will average in the following regions over the next 5 years?

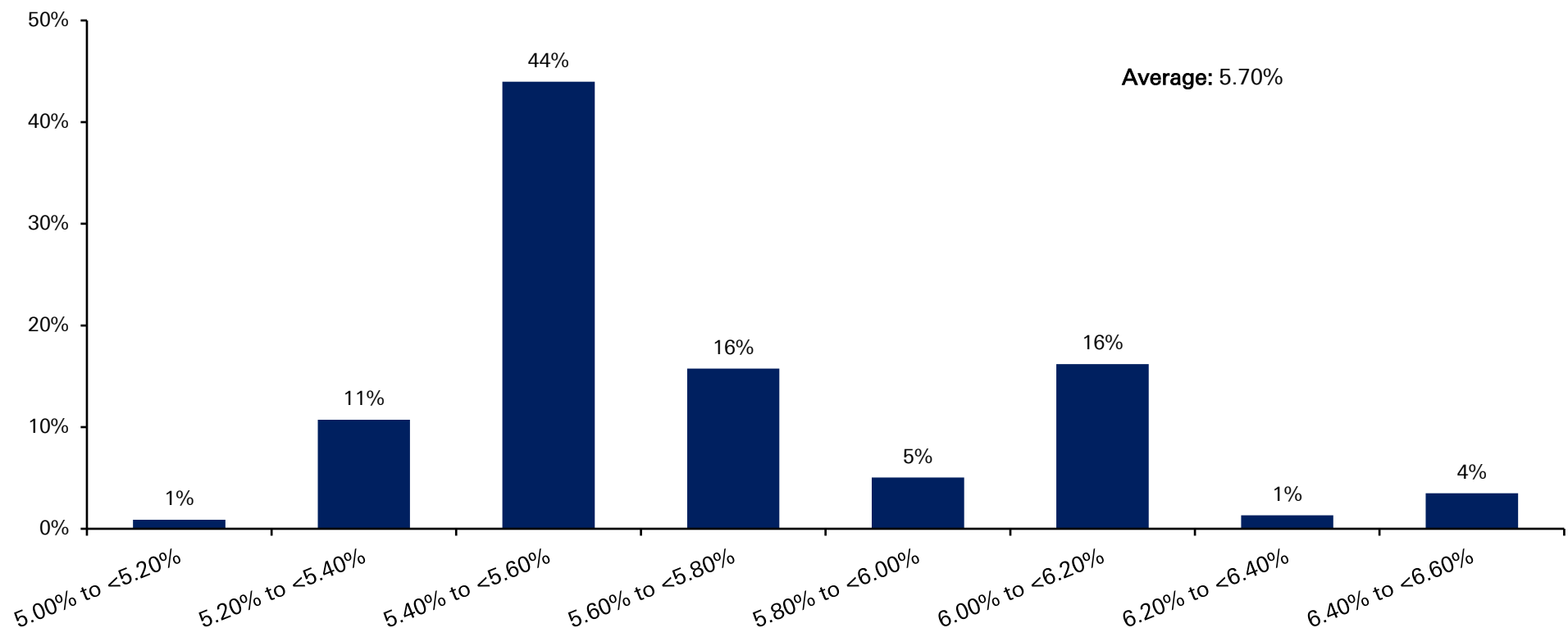


Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research



Despite US Treasury yields reaching multi-decade highs in September, most respondents expect the peak in rates to be higher over the next 12 months. The average expected peak in the 10-year yield is 5.70%, with most expecting around 5.5% but with a longish tail and a secondary peak around 6%.

Over the next 12 months, what do you expect will be the peak level reached by the 10-year US Treasury yield? For reference, the most recent intraday peak was 5.22%.

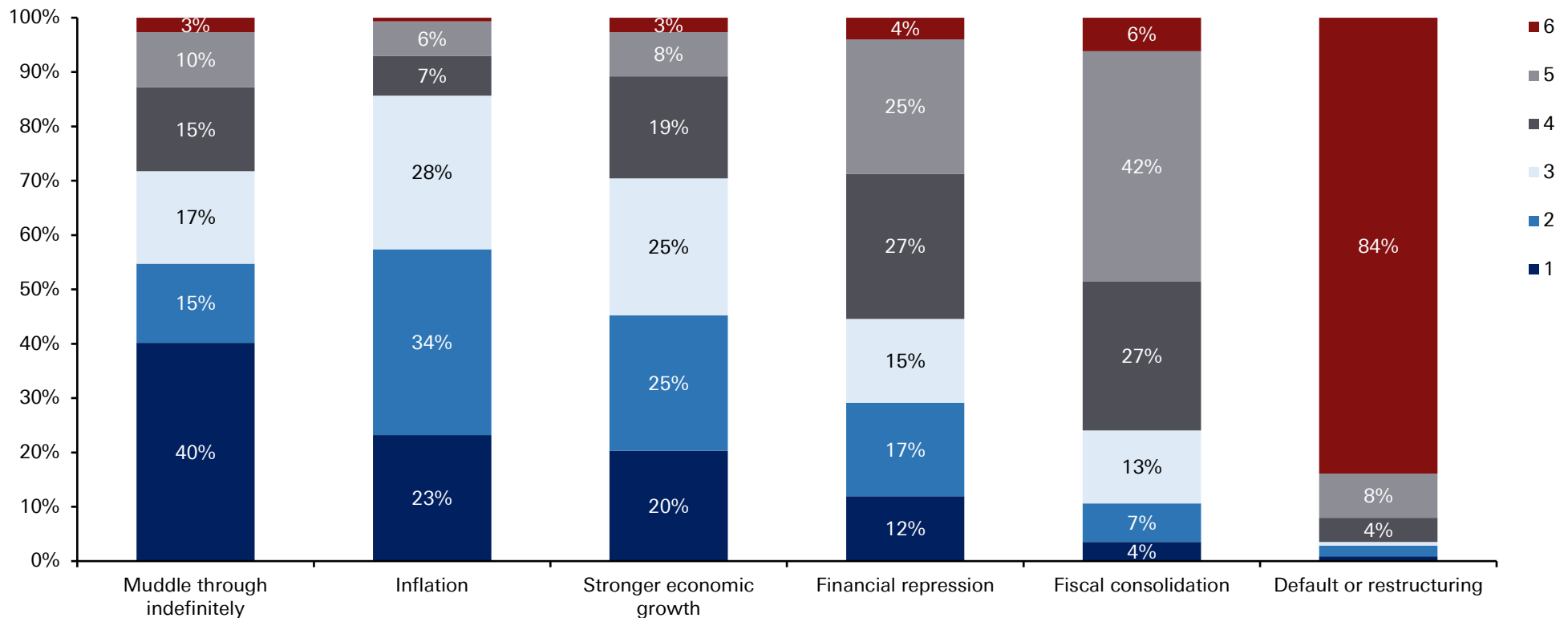


Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research

Interestingly, most respondents feel that the US will ultimately address its debt burden through a combination of muddling through it indefinitely, followed by inflating it away, and stronger economic growth. Fiscal consolidation is well down the list with only default lower (overwhelmingly so) as an option.



Please rank the following approaches according to how likely you think they are to be the way the US ultimately addresses its debt burden, from most likely to least likely. Drag and drop the options below, placing the most likely approach at the top and the least likely at the bottom.

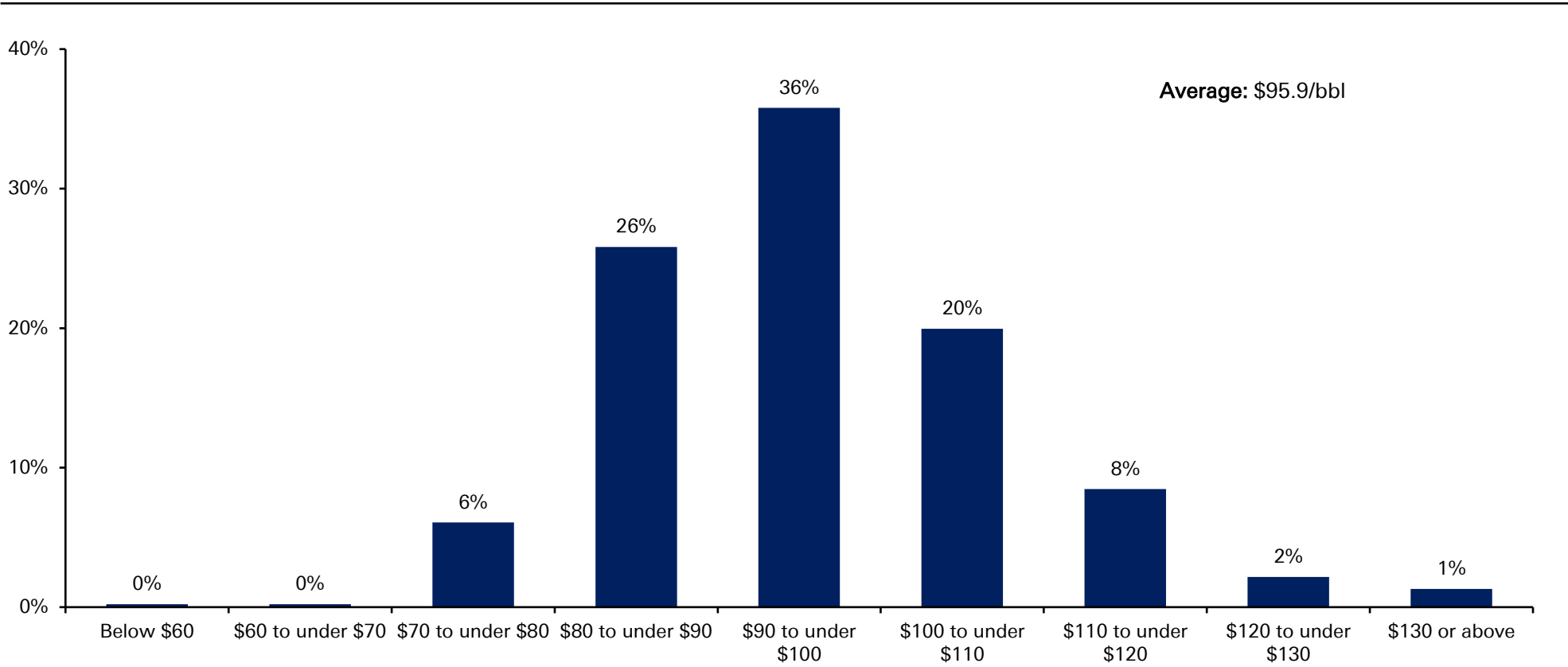


Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research

Brent is expected to be at \$95.9/bbl by the end of the year, with around 68% believing it will be below \$100/bbl.



Brent crude oil prices started the year at around \$60, rose to approximately \$70 prior to the Iran conflict, peaked near \$120, and have recently been around \$105. With this in mind, where do you expect Brent crude prices to end the year?

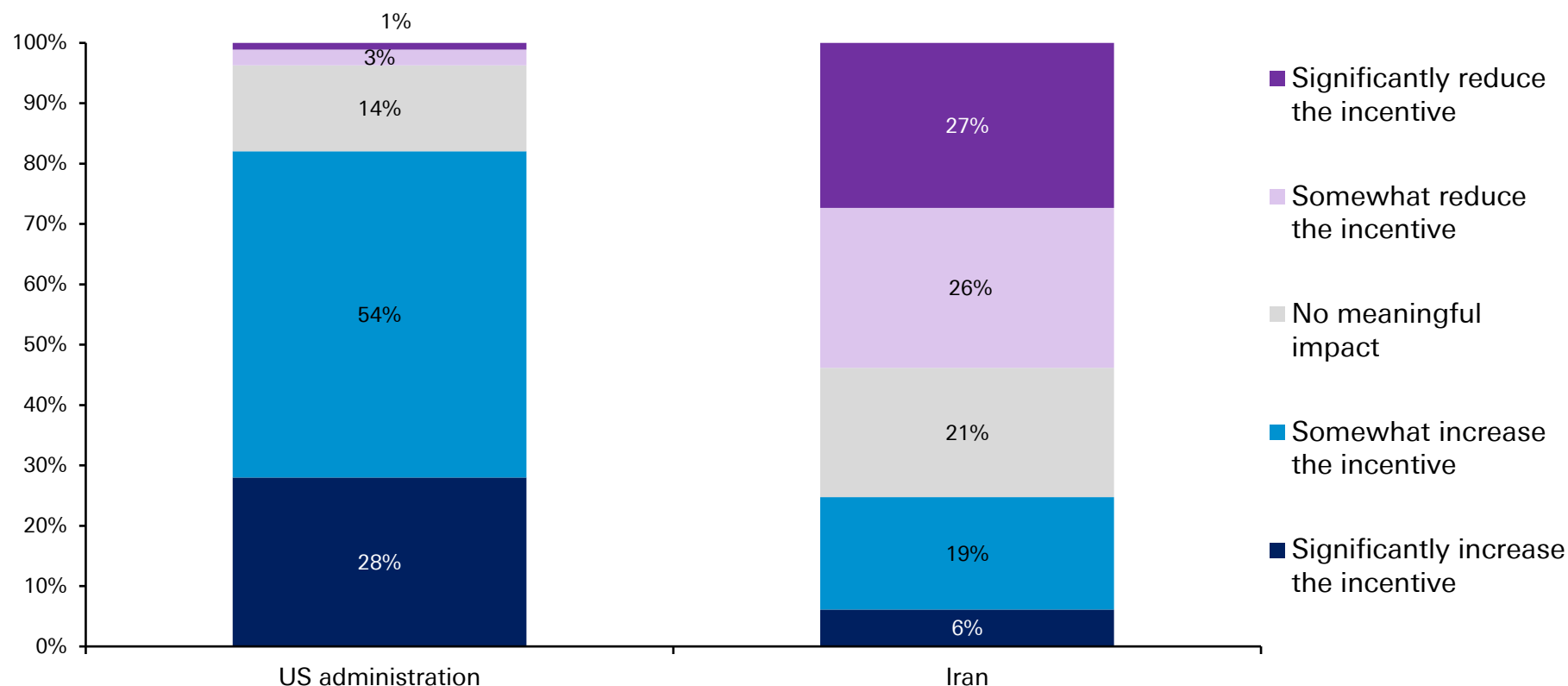


Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research

Ahead of the midterm elections, respondents see stronger political incentives for a deal in Washington vs Tehran. Specifically, 82% believe the vote increases the incentives for the US to do a deal vs 54% who believe the vote reduces it for the Iranians.



Ahead of the US midterm elections on 3 November, to what extent do domestic political considerations increase or reduce each side's incentive to reach a deal on the Iran conflict?

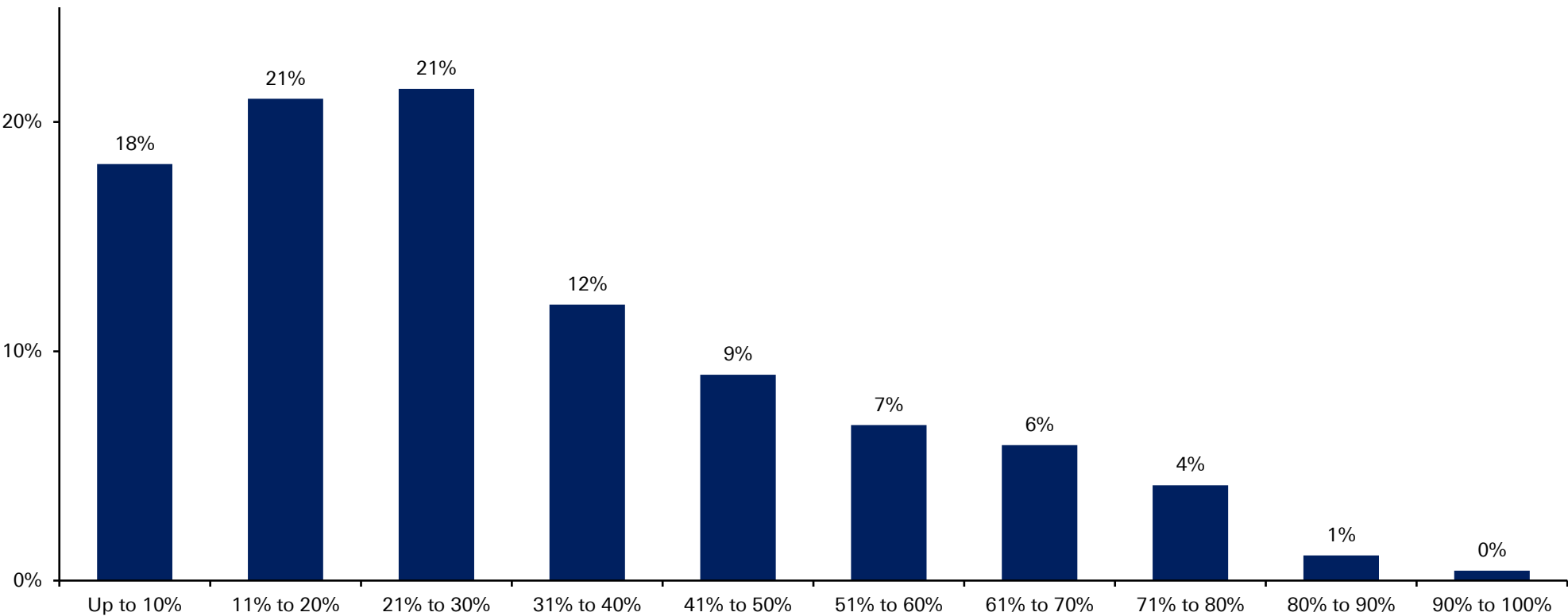


Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research

The majority (82%) think the probability of a US-Iran ceasefire or peace deal happening before the midterms stands at 50% or less.



What do you think is the probability of a deal being reached, or a durable ceasefire being agreed, in the Iran conflict before the US midterm elections on 3 November? Please move the slider to indicate your best estimate. Responses will be grouped into ranges for analysis.

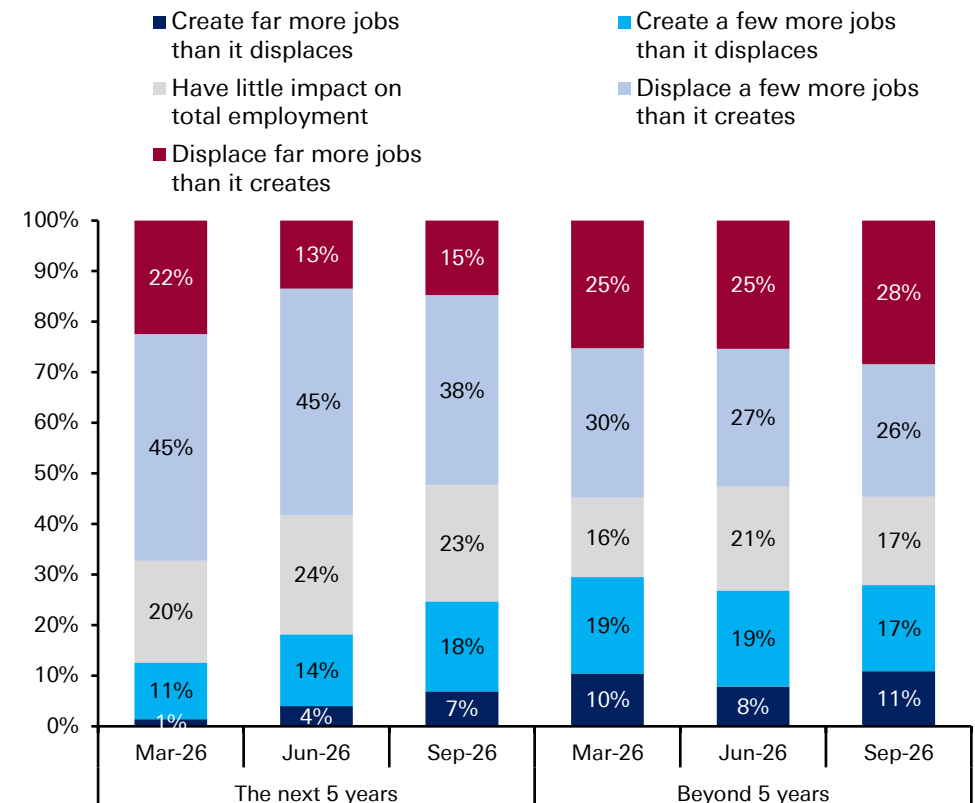
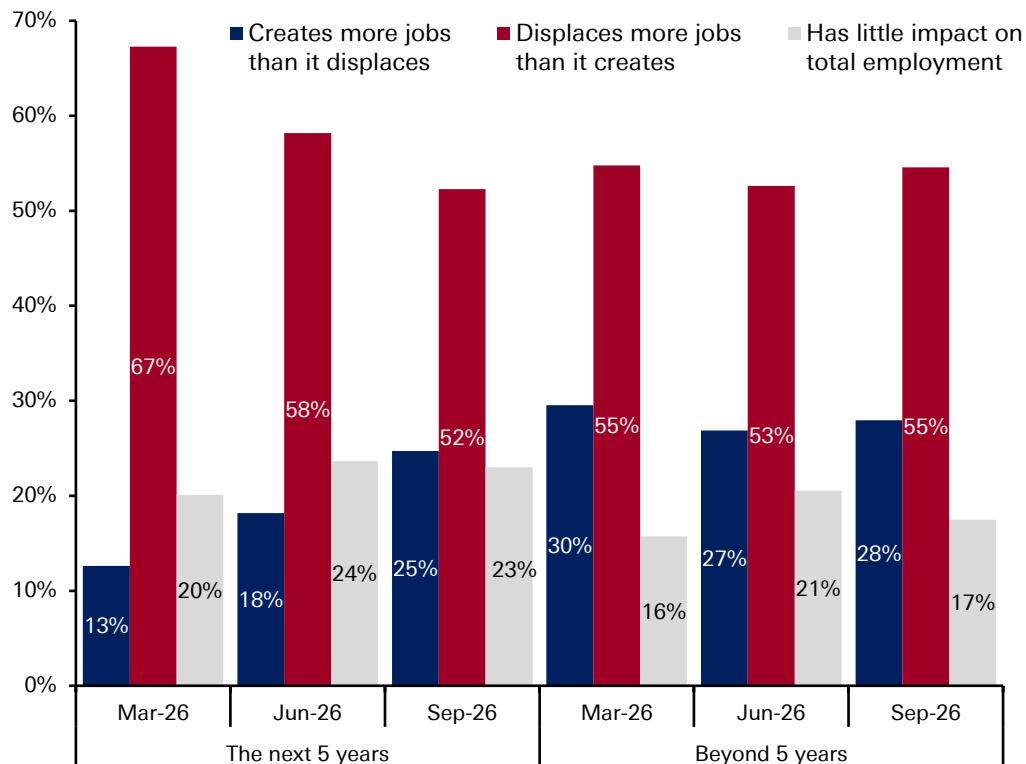


Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research



Near-term fears of AI-driven job displacement have eased markedly since March, but longer-term expectations remain negative and stable. The share expecting net job displacement over the next 5 years has fallen from 67% in March to 52%, while the longer-term figure remains around 55%. The first chart aggregates. The second is more granular.

For the following time horizons, which best describes your expectation for AI's impact on employment? Assume a scenario where AI adoption stays on its current trajectory. AI will...

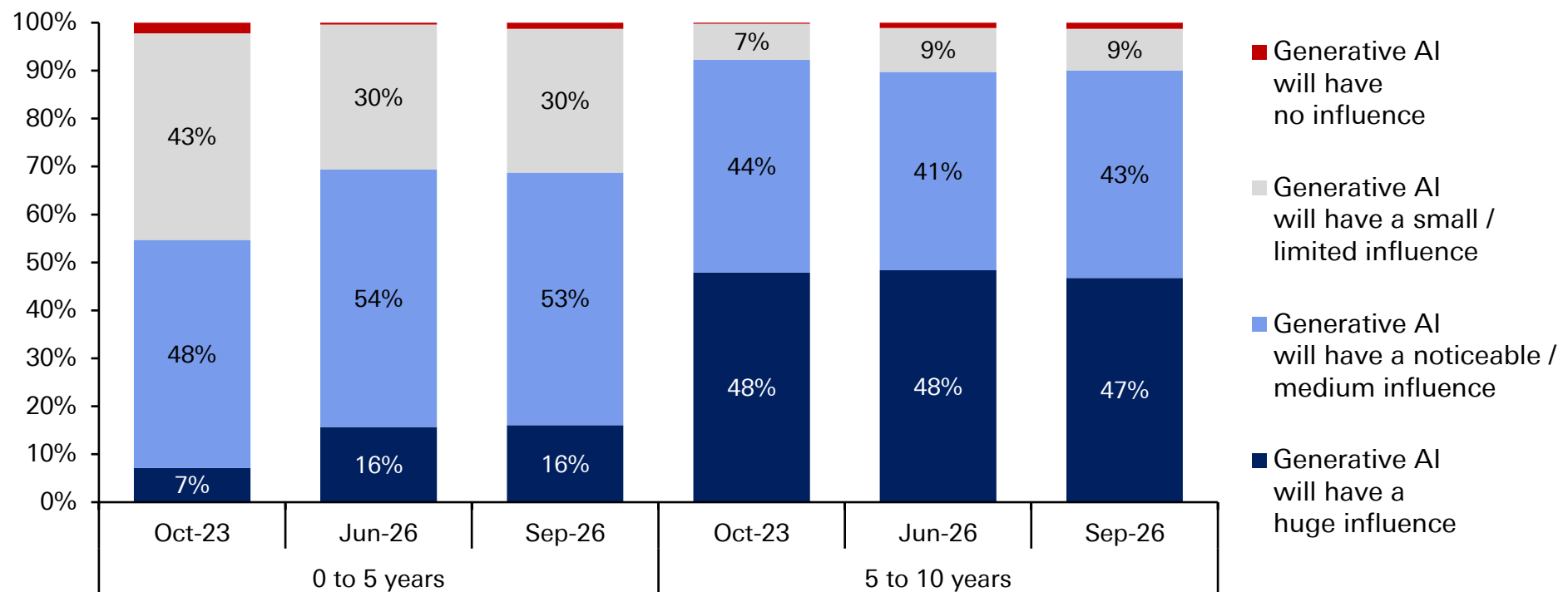


Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research

GenAI productivity growth expectations seem to have stabilised, with the strongest impact still expected over the longer term. Less than 1% believe AI will have no positive impact on growth.



What influence, if any, do you think future iterations of Generative AI will have on productivity growth within the following time frames...

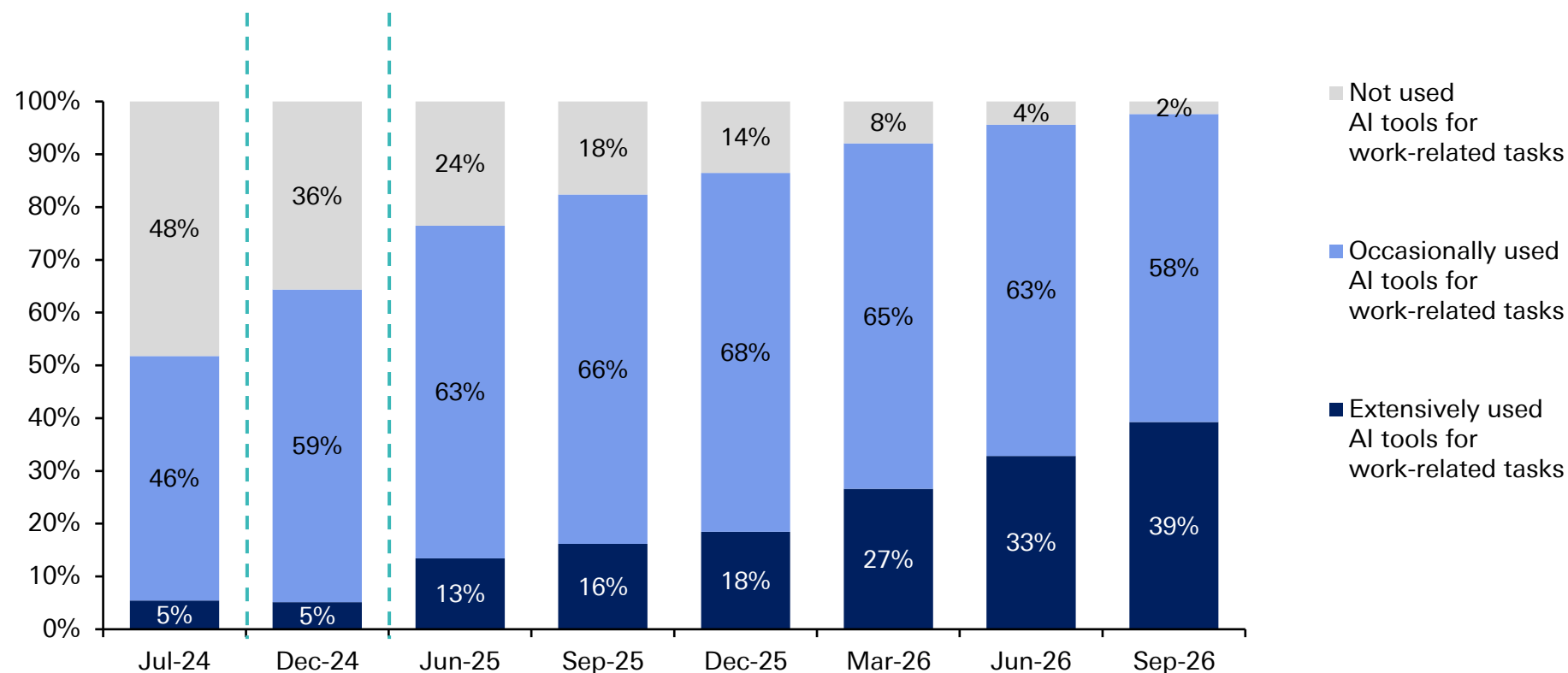


Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research

AI adoption at work continues to accelerate over this year alone. Now only 2% have not used AI for work, compared to 8% in March and 14% last December. “Extensively used” has also risen from 18% to 39% since December.



Which of the following best describes your use of AI tools for work-related tasks within the last three months? I have...

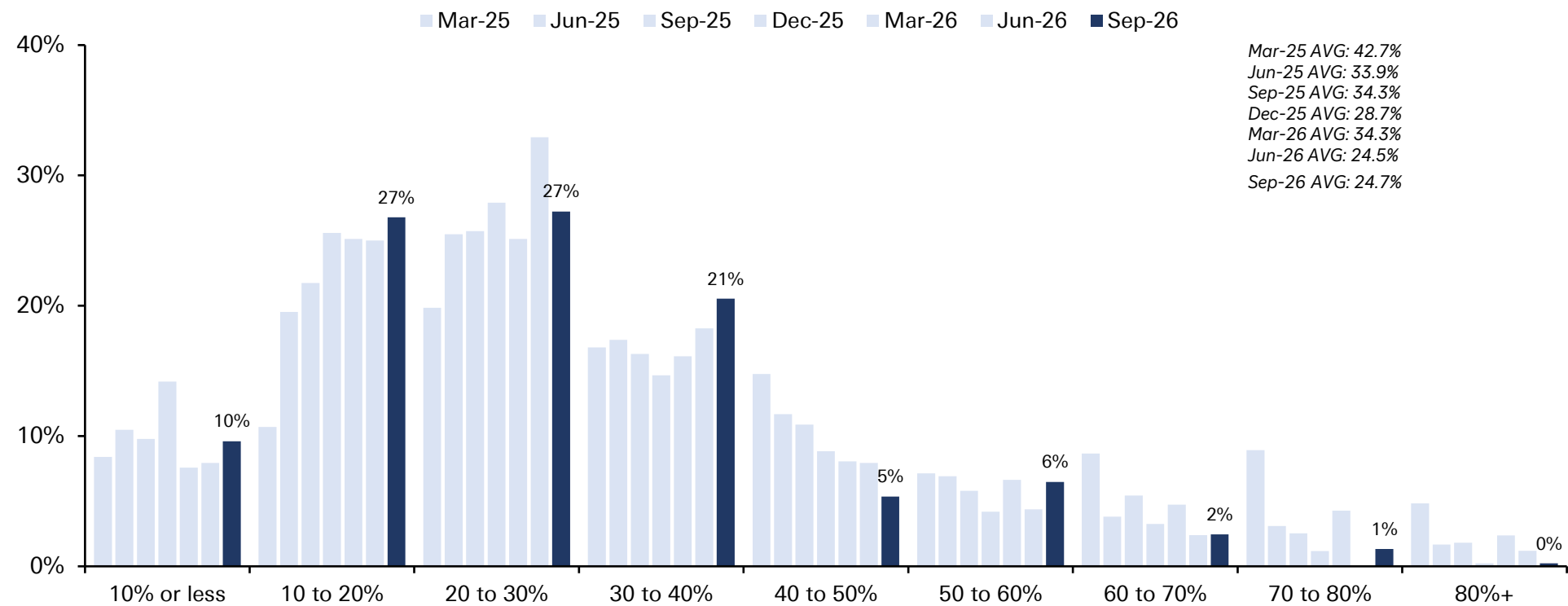


Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research

Average 12-month US recession-risk expectations have edged up a fraction to 24.7% since June but remain near survey lows with most respondents still concentrated in the 10-30% probability range.



What do you think the probability of there being a US recession in the next 12 months is?

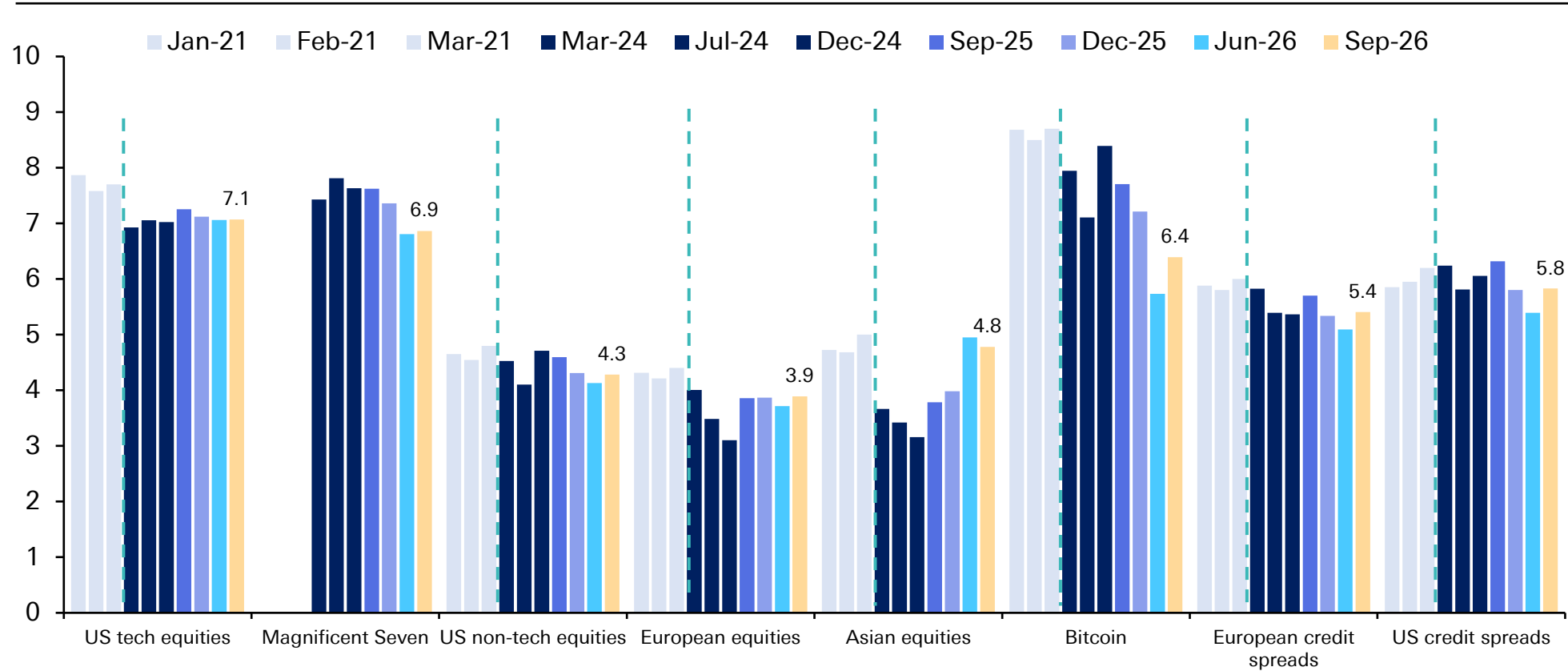


Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research



Bubble-risk perception has risen in several assets since we last asked this question in June. The Mag 7 has inched up to 6.9 from 6.8 previously, while Bitcoin registered a bigger jump to 6.4 from 5.7. Notably, bubble-risk perceptions for both European and US credit spreads have also risen, with the US back to its December 2025 levels. European and non-US tech equities have the lowest perceived risk.

Looking at the following assets and using a scale of 0 to 10 where 0 means ‘No Bubble’ and 10 means ‘Extreme Bubble’, please tell us where you think these assets currently are?

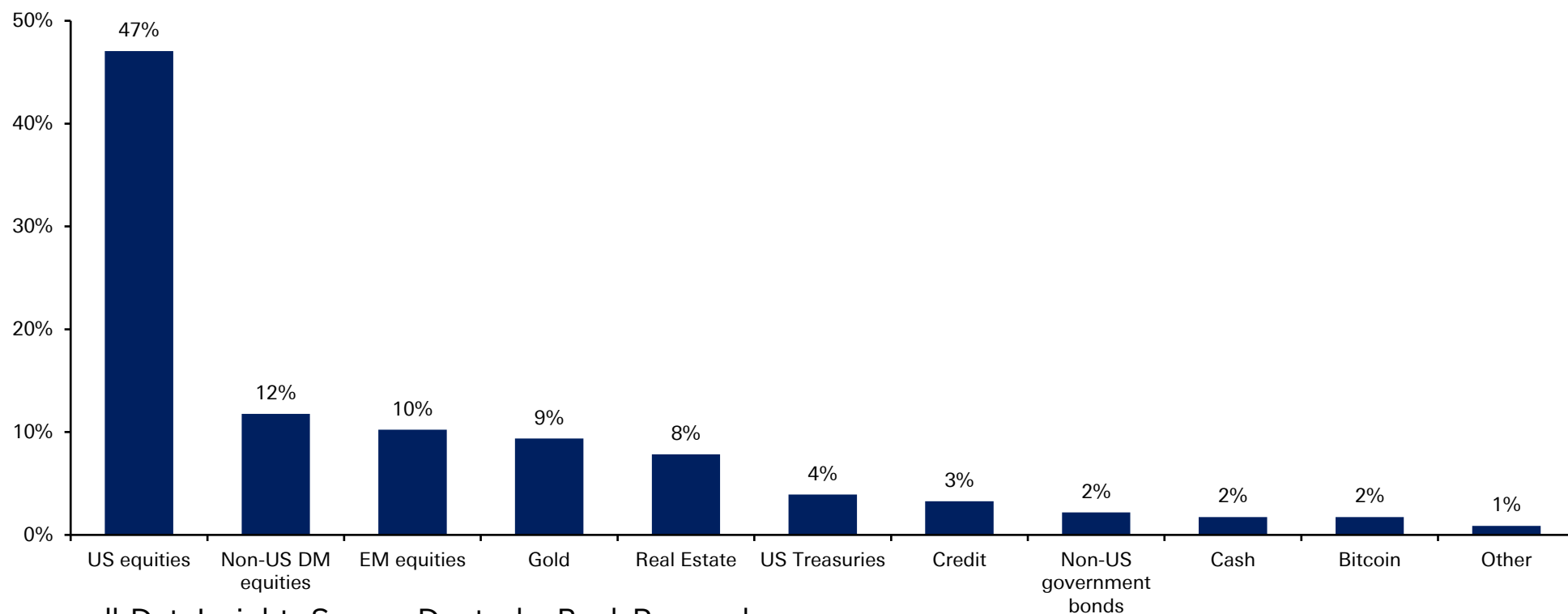


Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research.

Despite the higher perceived bubble risk, nearly half of respondents would choose US equities as their sole asset for the next decade. So confidence in US equities seems to be unrivalled for long-term returns, despite market concerns of elevated valuations.



If you could hold only one of the following assets for the next 10 years, which would you choose.



Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research

Appendix 1

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